

Cody Moser

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR
SCHOOL OF COLLECTIVE INTELLIGENCE
MOHAMMED VI POLYTECHNIC UNIVERSITY

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Academic Employment

Mohammed VI Polytechnic University (UM6P)

SCHOOL OF COLLECTIVE INTELLIGENCE

Assistant Professor non-HDR

Rabat, Morocco

2025-Present

Education and Research Experience

University of California, Merced

PHD COGNITIVE AND INFORMATION SCIENCES

- Advisor: Dr. Paul Smaldino
- Committee: Tyler Marghetis, Alex Petersen, Justin Yeakel
- Dissertation: "Epistemic Ecologies: Structure and Agency in Dynamics of Collective Thought"

Merced, CA

2025

MS COGNITIVE AND INFORMATION SCIENCES

- Thesis: "Design Principles of Generative Adaptive Systems"

University of California, Los Angeles

GRADUATE FELLOW, INSTITUTE FOR PURE AND APPLIED MATHEMATICS (IPAM)

- Program: Mathematics of Intelligence

Los Angeles, CA

Fall 2024

Harvard University

VISITING FELLOW, GRADUATE SCHOOL OF ARTS AND SCIENCES

- Principal Investigator: Dr. Samuel Mehr
- Affiliated Department: Psychology

Boston, MA

2018-2022

Texas A&M University

MA ANTHROPOLOGY

- Advisor: Dr. Jeffrey Winking
- Thesis: "Aggressive Mimicry as a Human Hunting Strategy"

College Station, TX

2019

Florida State University

BS ANTHROPOLOGY, MINORS IN BIOLOGY AND STATISTICS

- Thesis advisors: Drs. Elizabeth Peters, Dean Falk, Emily Lemmon
- Honor's Thesis: "Anti-Predator Behaviors in Nocturnal Strepsirrhines"

Tallahassee, FL

2016

Professional Experience

- 2022-2026 **Oskar Morgenstern Fellow**, Mercatus Center, George Mason University
- 2020 **Transportation Policy Intern**, Reason Foundation
- 2020 **Poverty and Inequality in California Research Project Intern**, Cato Institute
- 2015-2016 **Lab Assistant**, Center for Anchored Phylogenomics

Publications

*Denotes co-principal authorship; ¹Awarded “Feature paper” by journal

REFEREED PUBLICATIONS

- *Garg, K., **Moser, C.**, Dromiack, H., Anwarzai, Z., & Ramos-Fernandez, G. (In press). The causal role of synergy in collective problem-solving. *npj Complexity*.
- *Anwarzai, Z., ***Moser, C.**, Dromiack, H., Gark, K., & Ramos-Fernandez, G. (2026). Collective Intelligence as Collective Information Processing. *Cognition*, 270: 106433.
- Smaldino, P. E., Russell, A., Zefferman, M., Donath, J., Foster, J., Guilbeault, D., ... **Moser, C.**, ... Patt, D. (2025). Information Architectures: A Framework for Understanding Socio-Technical Systems. *npj Complexity*, 2: 13.
- Moser, C.**, Holbrook, C., Ellks, R., & Jones, A. (2025). Possessing Potential Weapons (Still) Heightens Anger Perception: Replicating and Extending a Test of Error Management Theory. *PLOS ONE*.
- Smaldino, P. E., **Moser, C.**, Pérez Velilla, A., Werling, M. (2024). Maintaining transient diversity is a general principle for improving collective problem solving. *Perspectives on Psychological Science*.
- Moser, C.**, & Smaldino, P. E. (2023). Innovation-Facilitating Networks Create Inequality. *Proceedings of the Royal Society B: Biological Sciences*, 290: 20232281.
- Falandays, J. B., Kaaronen, R. O., **Moser, C.**, Rorot, W., Tan, J., Varma, V., Williams, T., Youngblood, M. (2023). All Intelligence is Collective Intelligence. *Journal of Multiscale Neuroscience*, 2(1), 169-191.
- Moser, C.**, Buckner, W., Sarian, M., Winking, J. (2023). Aggressive Mimicry and the Evolution of the Human Cognitive Niche. *Human Nature*.
- *Hilton, C. B., ***Moser, C.**, Bertolo, M., Lee-Rubin, H., Amir, D., Bainbridge, C. M., ... & Mehr, S. A. (2022). Acoustic regularities in infant-directed speech and song across cultures. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 1-12.
- ¹**Moser, C.**, & Smaldino, P. E. (2022). Organizational Development as Generative Entrenchment. *Entropy*, 24(7), 879.
- Holbrook, C., Yoon, L., Fessler, D. M. T., **Moser, C.**, Delgado, J. D., Kim, H. (2022). Moral Parochialism and Causal Appraisal of Transgressive Harm in Seoul and Los Angeles. *Scientific Reports*, 12, 14227.

REFEREED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

- *Milzman, J. & ***Moser, C.** (2023). Decentralized core-periphery structure in social networks accelerates cultural innovation in an agent-based model. In Proc. of the 22nd International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multiagent Systems (AAMAS 2023), London, United Kingdom, May 29 – June 2, 2023, IFAAMAS.

COMMENTARIES & WHITE PAPERS

- Abbas, M., Alharthi, D., Balbas, J., Beckelhymer, D., Beylkin, G., Bruna, P., ... **Moser, C.**, ... Zhu, Y. (2025). White Paper: “Mathematics of Intelligences.” Institute for Pure and Applied Mathematics. <https://www.ipam.ucla.edu/reports>
- Moser, C.** (2025). Myth as Model: Group-Level Interpretive Frameworks. [commentary on Sijlmasi et al.]. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 47.
- Peréz Velilla, A., **Moser, C.**, Smaldino, P. E. (2022). Hidden Clusters Beyond Ethnic Boundaries. [commentary on Uchiyama et al.] *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 45.
- Moser, C.**, Ackerman, J., Dayer, A., Proksch, S., Smaldino, P. E. (2021). Why don't cockatoos have war songs? [commentary on Mehr et al. and Savage et al.]. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 44.

ARTICLES SUBMITTED

- Moser, C.**, & Smaldino, P.E. (2025). Limit Cycles in Opinion Dynamic Networks with Competing Stubborn Agents. <https://osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/nqbdv1>
- Moser, C.**, Ortega, A., & Marghetis, T. (2025). Network structure explains intellectual discourse across human history. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/ep3ub_v3

Presentations

CONTRIBUTED TALKS

- Moser, Cody**, Ortega, A., Marghetis, T. 2026. Network structure explains intellectual discourse across human history. Cultural Evolution Society 2026 Conference.
- Johnson, Katrina, **Moser, C.** 2026. Rejection and Ghosting with Reputational Costs. Cultural Evolution Society 2026 Conference.
- Moser, Cody**, Muldoon, R. 2025. Club Formation and the Limits of Polycentric Governance. Markets & Society 2025 Conference.
- Moser, Cody**. 2025. The Role of Central Actors in Intellectual Innovation. California Workshop on Evolutionary Social Science.
- Moser, Cody**. 2024. Gradient Descent with Modification: Wright's Adaptive Landscape and the Candidate Solutions Approach to Intelligence. IPAM Junior Seminar Series.
- Moser, Cody**. 2024. Innovation-Facilitating Networks Create Inequality. Markets & Society 2024 Conference.
- Moser, Cody**. 2024. Identifying leverage points in opinion dynamic networks with external influences. Institute for Humane Studies 2024 Graduate Conference.
- Moser, Cody**. 2023. Innovation-Facilitating Networks Create Inequality. Templeton World Charity Foundation Diverse Intelligences Summit
- Milzman, Jesse, **Moser, C.** 2023. Decentralized core-periphery structure in social networks accelerates cultural innovation in an agent-based model. International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multiagent Systems.
- Moser, Cody**. 2022. The Network Science of Cumulative Innovations. Institute for Humane Studies 2022 Graduate Conference.
- Moser, Cody**. 2021. Structural and Mechanistic Analogies in Evolutionary Thinking. California Workshop on Evolutionary Social Science

CONTRIBUTED POSTERS

- Moser, Cody**, Johnson, K. 2024. Don't Say No: A Game Theoretic Model of Rejection with Reputational Costs. PPE Society Eighth Annual Meeting.
- Clemotte, Clifford, **Moser, C.** 2024. The Ecological Origins of Property: An Extension of Wilson's Evolutionary Account of Property-Rights Cognition. PPE Society Eighth Annual Meeting.
- Moser, Cody**, Milzman, J. 2023. Decentralized core-periphery structure in social networks accelerates cultural innovation in an agent-based model. Santa Fe Institute Collective Intelligence Symposium.
- Milzman, Jesse, **Moser, C.** 2023. Decentralized core-periphery structure in social networks accelerates cultural innovation in an agent-based model. 22nd International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multiagent Systems.
- Moser, Cody**. 2022. The Network Science of Cumulative Innovations. 8th International Conference on Computational Social Science.
- Moser, Cody**. 2019. Aggressive Mimicry as a Human Hunting Strategy. Human Behavior and Evolution Society 31st Annual Conference.
- Moser, Cody**, et al. 2019. Acoustical Regularities in Infant-Directed Vocalizations Worldwide. Acoustical Society of America 177th Meeting.
- Gursky, Sharon, **Moser, C.** 2018. Echolocation in a nocturnal primate? American Association of Physical Anthropologists 87th Annual Meeting.
- Moser, C.** 2016. Anti-predator behaviors in four species of nocturnal strepsirrhine. American Association of Physical Anthropologists 85th Annual Meeting.

Moser, C. 2015. Spatial height preferences in wild *Cebus capucinus*.
American Association of Physical Anthropologists 84th Annual Meeting.

INVITED TALKS

Summer 2025. *Quantifying the Role of Central Actors in Systems of Thought*.
Plectics Laboratories Interdisciplinary Colloquium.

Spring 2025. *Measuring Agent-Level Contributions to Collective Problem-Solving*.
Network Science Group, Department of Mathematics, UCLA.

Spring 2025. *Dynamics and Structure in Epistemic Ecologies*.
Department of Natural Philosophy and History of Science, Charles University, Prague.

Fall 2024. *Bringing the Individual into Collective Intelligence*.
Center for Behavior, Evolution, and Culture, UCLA.

Summer 2024. *Philosophical Energy and the Sociology of Philosophies*.
Institute for Humane Studies Fellows Summer Workshop.

Fall 2023. *Organizational Development as Generative Entrenchment*.
Prosocial World Case Studies in Cultural Evolution Working Group.

Spring 2023. *Innovation-Facilitating Networks Create Inequality*.
Santa Fe Institute Information Architectures as Sociotechnical Competitions Workshop.

Spring 2023. *Innovation-Facilitating Networks Create Inequality*.
Future Gallo School of Management External Advisory Council Meeting, UC Merced.

Fall 2022. *Little Fish in Small Ponds Panel: Early Career Researchers in Big Science*.
2022 Big Team Science Conference.

Fall 2022. *Acoustic Regularities in Infant-directed Speech and Song Across Cultures*.
UC Merced Developmental Psychology Colloquium.

Spring 2022. *Acoustic Regularities in Infant-directed Speech and Song Across Cultures*.
University of Cambridge Centre for Music and Science Colloquium.

Spring 2021. *Theory of Mind Towards Non-Human Animals*.
Yale Department of Psychology Computational Social Cognition Group.

Fall 2016. *Anti-Predator Behaviors in Four Species of Nocturnal Strepsirrhine*.
Duke Lemur Center 50th Anniversary Symposium.

Non-Academic Articles

- 2023 **Works in Progress Magazine**, On the origins of empathy for other species
- 2022 **Hungarian Conservative Print Edition Special Issue on Conservatism and Innovation**, The Ties That Bind Us
Quillette Magazine, Saving Twitter – A Roundtable w/ Bo Winegard, Jim Rutt, Cody Moser
- 2020 **Areo Magazine**, Freeman Dyson, *In Memoriam*
Reason.org, Driver's License Suspensions and Fees Unfairly Impact the Poor And Are in Need of Reform
- 2019 **Skeptic Magazine 24.3**, The Enigma of Stephen Jay Gould
Areo Magazine, There's Little Reason to Worry About the SAT's New Adversity Score
Areo Magazine, "Is Science Racist?" Book Review
- 2018 **Areo Magazine**, The Selfish Nature of Human Cooperation
Quillette Magazine, The Dangers of Dugin's Particularism
Areo Magazine, Alice Dreger's Middle Finger: Sex, Gender and Unhelpful Hair-Splitting

Fellowships & Awards

2026	Oskar Morgenstern Fellowship, The Mercatus Center	\$ 7,000
2025	Legacy Leadership Award, UC Merced Office of Leadership	
	Oskar Morgenstern Fellowship, The Mercatus Center	\$ 7,000
2024	Fletcher Jones Fellowship, UC Merced, Fletcher Jones Foundation	\$ 50,000
	Junior Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies	\$ 6,000
2023	Oskar Morgenstern Fellowship, The Mercatus Center	\$ 7,000
	Winning Research Proposal, SFI Complexity-GAIs Workshop on Representation and Intelligence	
	Cognitive & Information Sciences Graduate Student Spotlight Award, UC Merced Department of Cognitive and Information Sciences	
	DISI Alumni Award, Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute	\$ 750
2022	Oskar Morgenstern Fellowship, The Mercatus Center	\$ 7,000
2021	Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies	\$3,000
2016	International Awareness Fellowship, Texas A&M MSC LT Jordan Institute	\$2,000
2015	Florida State University Homepage Featured Student, Florida State University	

Grants

2025	Institute for Humane Studies Travel Grant, <i>for CSH Vienna International Winter School on Social Complexity</i>	\$ 1,000
2024	Institute for Humane Studies Faculty Mentorship Grant, <i>with Dr. Ryan Muldoon, University at Buffalo</i>	\$ 8,000
	Institute for Humane Studies Event Support Grant, <i>Event Funding: Understanding the Emergence of Group Knowledge in Social Systems: Complexity, Synergy, and Innovation in Social Groups</i>	\$ 3,500
	Institute for Humane Studies Travel Grant, <i>for PPE Society 8th Annual Meeting</i>	\$ 1,300

2023	Institute for Humane Studies Publication Accelerator Grant, <i>for Identifying Leverage Points in Opinion Dynamic Networks with External Influence</i>	\$ 5,000
	UC Merced Office of the Dean of Social Sciences, Humanities and Arts Grant, <i>Event Funding: CWESS 2023</i>	\$ 5,000
	UC Merced Center for Analytic Political Engagement (CAPE), <i>for How Effective Media Propaganda Works in Social Networks</i>	\$ 700
	Mercatus Center Travel Award, <i>for SFI Collective Intelligence Symposium</i>	\$ 200
	AAMAS Student Scholarship, <i>for AAMAS 2023</i>	\$ 460
	Institute for Humane Studies Hayek Travel Award, <i>for AAMAS 2023</i>	\$ 750
2022	UC Merced Graduate Student Association Travel Award, <i>for IC2S2 2022</i>	\$ 400
	Institute for Humane Studies Hayek Travel Award, <i>for CSH Vienna International Spring School on Social Complexity</i>	\$ 800
	UC Merced Graduate Fellowship Incentive Award, <i>for External Grant Applications</i>	\$ 200
2016	TAMU Department of Anthropology Pilot Research Funding Award , <i>for Ultrasonic Communication in Bornean Tarsiers</i>	\$ 2,400
	Murray & Celeste Fasken Chair in Liberal Arts Research Award, <i>for Ultrasonic Communication in Bornean Tarsiers</i>	\$ 500
2015	ACC Undergraduate Collaborative Summer Research Award, <i>for Anti-Predator Behaviors in Nocturnal Strepsirrhines</i>	\$ 5,000

Course Instructor _____

2026	Theory of the Firm, Africa Business School
2026	Modeling for Collective Intelligence, School of Collective Intelligence
2026	Facilitation and Consulting, School of Collective Intelligence
2026	Masterpieces of Philosophy and Literature, UM6P Vanguard Center (Plato, Aristotle, Philosophy of Computation)
2025	Leadership and Organizations, School of Collective Intelligence
2025-26	Collective Intelligence: Scientific Training in the Field, School of Collective Intelligence

Teaching Assistant _____

2024	Modeling Social Behavior, Teaching Assistant
2020, '23	Introduction to Cognitive Science, Teaching Assistant
2023	Senior Thesis Writing Course, Teaching Assistant
2022	Language and Linguistics, Teaching Assistant
2021	Philosophy of Cognitive Science, Teaching Assistant
2017	Peoples and Cultures of the World, Teaching Assistant
2016-2018	Introduction to Anthropology, Teaching Assistant

Outreach & Professional Development

WORKSHOPS & TRAINING

- 2026 **Arab Center for Research**, Arab Liberty Forum 2026
- 2025 **Axioma Center**, Mit Jelent Embernek Lenni? (What It Means to Be Human) Conference
- Institute for Human Ecology and The Thomistic Institute**, Civitas Dei Fellowship on The Future of Personhood and the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence
- Complexity Science Hub**, Winter School on Complex Systems in Our Changing World
- 2024 ***Institute for Humane Studies**, Emergence of Group Knowledge in Social Systems: Complexity, Synergy, and Innovation in Social Groups
- *Santa Fe Institute**, Assessing Representation in Minds and Artificial Systems Workshop
- Berggruen Institute**, Computational Consciousness Workshop
- Chapman University**, Philosophy, Politics and Economics Graduate Summer Workshop
- Acton Institute**, The Person and Technological Society: A Free and Virtuous Society Workshop
- 2023 **Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute (DISI)**, University of St. Andrews
- Santa Fe Institute**, Complexity-GAINS International Summer School on Intelligence and Representation
- Santa Fe Institute**, Collective Intelligence Short Course
- Santa Fe Institute**, Information Architectures as Sociotechnical Competitions Workshop
- Institute for Humane Studies**, A Responsible Singularity: Tech Ethics and Unpredictable Change Workshop
- 2022 **Santa Fe Institute**, Complexity-GAINS International Summer School on Disintegration of Societies
- Complexity Science Hub**, International Spring School on Social Complexity
- Institute for Progress**, Economics of Ideas, Science, and Innovation PhD Course
- 2021 **National Science Foundation**, Societal Shock Resilience Workshop
- 2020 **Santa Fe Institute**, Evolution of Collective Computational Abilities of (Pre)Historical Societies Workshop

**Organizer role*

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

- 2025-26 **Core Pedagogical Committee**, UM6P School of Collective Intelligence
- PhD Program Pedagogical Committee**, UM6P School of Collective Intelligence
- Executive Programs Pedagogical Committee**, UM6P School of Collective Intelligence
- Scientific Committee**, 2026 Cultural Evolution Society Conference

OTHER SERVICE POSITIONS

- 2024 **Founder & Primary Coordinator**, UCM CogSci Mentorship for Undergraduates (MUG) Program
- Mentor**, UCM CogSci Mentorship for Undergraduates (MUG) Program
- 2021-24 **Graduate Student Mentor**, Cognitive Science Student Association at UC Merced
- Campus Representative**, California Workshop on Evolution Social Sciences
- Twitter Administrator**, UC Merced Department of Cognitive and Information Sciences
- 2022-23 **Senior Organizer**, California Workshop on Evolution Social Sciences
- 2021-22 **Junior Organizer**, California Workshop on Evolution Social Sciences
- 2016-18 **Coordinator**, Texas A&M Department of Anthropology Graduate-Undergraduate Mentorship Program
- Mentor**, Texas A&M Department of Anthropology Graduate-Undergraduate Mentorship Program
- Mentor**, Texas A&M GLBT+ Mentorship Program

PRIMARY ADVISING

Taha Zaamoun, Thesis Chair, M.A., Collective Intelligence, UM6P, 2025-
Imane Bachar, Thesis Chair, M.A., Collective Intelligence, UM6P, 2025-
Isabella Dohnke, MUG Mentor, Cognitive Science, UC Merced, 2024-2025

COMMITTEE ADVISING

Ghizlane Goubraim, Committee Member, PhD, Collective Intelligence, UM6P, 2025–

Khalida Bousrhal, Reader, M.A., Collective Intelligence, UM6P, 2025

Christianah Oyewale, Reader, M.A., Collective Intelligence, UM6P, 2025

SELECTED MEDIA COVERAGE

The Jim Rutt Show: Innovation-Facilitating Networks Create Inequality (12/19/2023)

The Guardian: Gaga for goo goo: Wellington named the global capital of baby talk (07/22/2022)

New York Times: Front cover, ‘Parentese’ Is Truly a Lingua Franca, Global Study Finds (07/25/2022)

The Today Show: Baby Talk is Universal (07/25/2022)

NPR, All Things Considered: The science is in: Everyone recognizes and uses baby talk with infants (07/31/2022)

NPR, Goats and Soda: Scholars confirm what itsy bitsy babies around the world already know (08/14/2022)

Every Little Thing Podcast: Why do we baby talk? (09/26/2022)

PEER REVIEW

Journals:

Behavioral Ecology

Child Development

Cognition and Emotion

Cognitive Science

Developmental Science (2)

Evolution and Human Behavior (4)

Evolutionary Human Sciences (2)

Humanities and Social Sciences Communications

Journal of Mathematical Sociology

Nature Human Behaviour

npj Complexity

Organization Science

Physica A

PLOS One

PNAS

PNAS Nexus (2)

Philosophy of Science

Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society B

Proceedings of the Royal Society B

Royal Society Open Science (2)

Synthese

Topics in Cognitive Science

Conferences:

CogSci 2024, 2025, 2026

Funding Agencies:

ManyLanguages Consortium

UK Research and Innovation Economic and Social Research Council (UKRI-ERSC)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

The Polanyi Society

Cultural Evolution Society

Long Now Foundation Member #11096

Human Behavior and Evolution Society

PROFICIENCIES, ETC.

Citizenship: United States, United Kingdom

Languages: English (native), German (intermediate), Japanese (beginner)

Programming: Python, R, NetLogo, MATLAB